User Guide

MitzNSimz Encounter Tracker · v1.118

PART 1 — START HERE

Why This Tracker Exists

Running combat in D&D 5e requires a Dungeon Master to simultaneously manage initiative, HP, conditions, concentration, legendary actions, ability recharges, and round flow — all while narrating the scene and keeping players engaged.

The MitzNSimz Encounter Tracker removes that friction so the DM can focus on what matters: **the story, the drama, and the players.**

Core Design Principles: Offline First · No Accounts · No Subscriptions · Local Data · DM-Focused · Physical Dice

What this tracker is not: not a Virtual Tabletop (no grid or maps), not a character sheet manager, not a dice roller, not a campaign manager.

Best viewed on: a tablet (iPad, Android tablet) or laptop/desktop browser gives the most room. Phones are fully supported too (v1.37): the toolbar becomes a single side-scrolling row, and when you start combat the header automatically collapses to a slim bar showing the round, the active combatant and a **Next** button — handing the rest of the screen to the combatant list. Scrolling down also collapses it; to bring the full header and footer back, tap the small chevron on the slim bar (it stays collapsed while you scroll so nothing flickers in and out). You can collapse or expand the header at any time with the chevron next to **? Help**.

Offline Use, Privacy & Data

Cookies

This tracker uses **no cookies** of any kind. No cookie consent is required. (Mitz & Simz, however, are always happy for treats.)

Privacy & GDPR

This tracker does not collect, store, transmit, or process any personal data. No user accounts, no analytics, no tracking, no third-party advertising. All data you enter — encounter names, combatant names, custom monsters, party configurations — is stored exclusively in your own browser's local storage (`localStorage` and `IndexedDB`) and never leaves your device.

The only external connection this tracker makes is to Open5e on first load to download the monster and spell database. No user data is included in that request. Once that download has completed and been cached, the tracker's combat features and the cached reference libraries work with no connection at all. (A completely fresh browser — or one whose storage has been cleared — needs one online visit to fetch the database again.)

The mini-shop link (v1.116): stat blocks in the Monster DB end with one optional "Looking for a mini?" link to the MitzNSimz shop. It is an ordinary link: nothing is sent anywhere unless you click it, and clicking it simply opens the shop's search page in a new tab. The only thing the shop receives is the search words shown in the link (e.g. "Goblin"). The tracker adds **no tracking code**, and the link is set so your browser doesn't even say which page you came from — the visit looks exactly as if you had searched the shop yourself. Once you're on the shop you're an ordinary visitor to that website, covered by its own privacy policy. Don't want it? **More > Mini Shop Links: Off**.

The tracker is designed to minimise privacy concerns: there are no accounts, no analytics, no third-party advertising and no server-side storage, and everything you enter stays in your browser on your own device. **MitzNSimz does not collect, receive or process any of it** — so there is nothing held about you for us to disclose, delete or export. Note that anything you type in (player names, for example) is still personal data *on your device*, and remains under your control: you are responsible for what you choose to enter and for any

backup files you export. Clearing your browser storage removes it all.

Local Storage & Offline Use

Your encounter data never leaves your device. The tracker stores everything locally — no cloud, no account, no server.

You need to be online once. On first open the monster and spell database downloads (~30–60 seconds). After that the tracker runs entirely offline — no connection needed at the table. The only time you need to be online again is to update the database on demand, or to re-fetch it if browser storage has been cleared (or you start fresh on another device or browser).

Full Backup (recommended) (v1.33): More > Full Backup saves all your custom data — parties, encounters, monster groups, custom monsters and custom spells — in one file. Restore Backup loads it back and asks whether to **Merge** (keep your current data, add anything new, skip duplicates) or **Clear & Replace** (wipe your current custom data first, then restore only the file). App preferences (theme, font, ruleset) are not part of the backup — re-set those after restoring.

Backup reminder (v1.40): under the Full Backup menu item, a small passive note shows when you last backed up and when your custom content last changed (e.g. “Last backup: 5 days ago · custom content changed today”). It’s just a gentle at-a-glance reminder — no popups, no nagging.

Storage used (v1.40): the Help panel’s *Offline Use* section shows roughly how much browser storage the app is using. The app also asks your browser to keep its data persistent, so the monster cache and your saved encounters are less likely to be cleared automatically when the device is low on space.

New content notice (v1.46): when you’re online, the tracker quietly asks Open5e how many creatures and spells it currently offers and compares that with your local cache (your custom monsters don’t count). If Open5e has grown, the caption under **Refresh Monster DB** gains a gentle note — e.g. “Open5e has 42 new monsters — refresh to sync.” A small gold badge also appears next to the database status in the header (with the count on wider screens); tap it to open the menu. No popups, nothing blocks, and offline it simply stays silent. And **Refresh Monster DB** itself is offline-safe (v1.52): it first checks that Open5e is reachable, and if it isn’t, your current database is left untouched and you’re told — clicking refresh while offline can never wipe your data.

Individual backups: you can still export each collection separately for sharing a single item — Encounters > Export All · Parties > Export · Groups > Export · Custom Monsters > Export · Spell Library > Export Spells.

Device Transfer: Full Backup on the old device > transfer the file > Restore Backup on the new device.

Typical Session Workflow

Before the Session

#	Action	Details
1	Open the tracker	mitznsimz-cpu.github.io/DnD-Encounter-Tracker
2	Load your party	Party & XP > Parties > Add to Encounter
3	Build the encounter	Monster DB search or Random Generator
4	Check difficulty	Party & XP shows Easy/Medium/Hard/Deadly

During Combat

#	Action	Details

5	Roll initiative	Click 20 Roll Init on toolbar (auto-rolls all using DEX modifier, resets round to 1), or click any badge and type manually.
6	Tiebreak by drag	Grab handle, drag card to position.
7	Click Next Turn	Active card highlights. Banner shows who is up.
8	Apply damage	Enter amount, press Enter or DMG.
9	Track conditions	Click Conditions. Set duration for auto-expiry.
10	Undo mistakes	Ctrl+Z restores full state.

End of Session

#	Action	Details
11	Save the fight	Encounters > Save Current Encounter keeps it in this browser. More > Quick Save downloads it as a file instead.
12	Export backup	More > Full Backup periodically (or per-collection exports).

Quick Start

Prefer one page you can print? The Table Card condenses the essentials — setting up, damage and conditions during the fight, ending the session, and the four keyboard shortcuts — onto a single sheet to keep beside the dice. It's also linked at the top of this Help panel.

1. Open in any modern browser. 2. First open: database downloads (~30-60s). 3. Load Sample Encounter or Start Empty. 4. Add combatants via + Add Combatant or Monster DB. 5. Click Next Turn (or press **N**) to start combat.

> **Tip:** Open with internet access before your session to pre-cache the database.

PART 2 — RUNNING ENCOUNTERS (everything you use during a fight)

Running Combat

Where the Stat Block Opens (v1.84)

When you open a combatant's stat block, it can appear in three different places. Choose from **More > Stat block**, which opens a short list explaining each option and remembers your choice:

- **Auto** (the default) — a side panel on wide screens, and below the card on narrow ones.
- **Side panel** — always beside the combatant list, whatever the screen size.
- **Below the card** — always underneath the combatant, keeping the full width for your cards.
- **Pop-up** — a floating window over the middle of the screen, like the spell pop-up. It doesn't block anything, so you can still damage, heal and take turns while it's open; close it with its button or the **Esc** key. Often the best choice on a phone or a smaller tablet, where neither of the other two has much room.

Resizing the side panel: drag the handle on its left edge to make it wider or narrower — this works with a mouse, a finger or a stylus. Double-tap or double-click the handle to return it to the default width. Your chosen width is remembered, and is automatically adjusted if you rotate a tablet or shrink the window so that both the panel and your cards always stay usable.

Moving the pop-ups (v1.87): drag a pop-up by its title bar to park it wherever suits you — with a mouse, a finger or a stylus. This works for both the stat-block pop-up and the spell pop-up. Double-click or double-tap the

title bar to send it back to where it started. The stat block remembers where you put it; the spell pop-up doesn't, because it deliberately opens next to whichever spell link you tapped. Dragging is switched off on phone-sized screens, where there is nowhere useful to move a pop-up anyway.

The combatant cards now measure the space they actually have rather than the size of the screen, so they rearrange themselves neatly however wide or narrow the stat block is — on a squeezed layout the row of buttons simply moves onto its own line.

When a Condition Ends (v1.100)

Fifth edition distinguishes two very similar-sounding durations, and which one applies changes whether a creature gets to act under the effect:

- **Until the end of their next turn** — the creature takes its whole turn still affected, and the condition drops as the turn finishes. This is the common case, and the default.
- **Until the start of their next turn** — the condition falls away as the creature's turn begins, so they act free of it.

When you set a duration, choose which applies. The tracker then counts down at the right moment: end-of-turn conditions expire as that creature finishes, start-of-turn conditions expire before they act. Conditions set to the start of a turn are marked with a small **s** beside the round count, and hovering the count tells you which it is.

Repeat saving throws. Many conditions let a creature try to shake the effect off on its own turn. When you set a duration you can record the save alongside it — pick the ability (STR, DEX, CON, INT, WIS or CHA) and type the DC. The condition then carries a small **CON 13** style badge, and that badge **lights up and pulses when it is that creature's turn**, so you are reminded to call for the roll at the right moment. The rest of the time it sits quietly out of the way.

The tracker deliberately doesn't resolve the save for you: you roll, and then remove, shorten or leave the condition as the result and the spell demand. Leave the ability blank if a condition has no repeat save.

When a condition runs out it doesn't simply vanish. It lingers for a couple of seconds, struck through and marked **expired**, then clears itself — so you can see *what* just ended and *when*, rather than noticing later that something is missing. This applies to both timings.

Existing conditions and older saved encounters are unaffected — anything without a choice recorded behaves as end-of-turn, exactly as before.

Passive Scores (v1.98)

AC and hit points (v1.105) can also be set here, beside each name, so a party's whole reference sheet lives in one place rather than being edited card by card. Leave them blank and the tracker keeps whatever the player's card already has. Changing them updates that player immediately — and sensibly: raising someone's maximum hit points doesn't secretly heal a wounded character, and lowering it won't leave them on more hit points than they now have.

Passive Perception, Investigation and Insight are the numbers a DM reaches for most often between rolls — who notices the ambush, who spots the lie, who sees through the disguise. You can record them per player in **Party & XP**, beside each name, and they then appear on that player's combatant card for reference during play.

- **Entirely optional.** Leave them blank and nothing changes — the card looks exactly as it did before.
- **Fill in only what you want.** If you only care about Passive Perception, set that and leave the other two empty; the card shows just the ones you've entered.
- **Saved with your party**, so they come back whenever you load that party or add it to an encounter, and they travel in a Full Backup.
- **Older parties still work.** Party configurations saved before this feature simply show blank boxes, ready to fill in if you want them.

This is deliberately a reference field and nothing more — the tracker isn't trying to manage character sheets, and most DMs will have those open in another tool anyway. It's here purely so the number is in front of you

when a player asks "do I notice anything?".

Finding a Combatant Quickly (v1.94)

In a big fight — five players and seventeen monsters, say — the list runs to several screens, and hunting for "Skeleton 2" to apply damage means a lot of scrolling. The **button** beside Next Turn opens a compact list of everyone in the encounter, in initiative order, on a single screen.

- **Type to filter.** Start typing a name (or an initiative number) and the list narrows as you go. On a computer the box is already focused, so you can type and press **Enter** to jump straight to the first match without touching the mouse.
- **Tap a name** and the tracker scrolls that combatant's card to the middle of the screen and highlights it briefly, so your eye lands in the right place. The list closes itself — it is purely a way of getting somewhere, and changes nothing.
- **The dot** beside each name shows condition at a glance: green for healthy, amber for bloodied, grey for defeated, and a hollow ring for an absent player. The combatant whose turn it is now is marked.
- If the one you pick is inside a collapsed group, or hidden because you are hiding defeated combatants, the tracker reveals it for you rather than doing nothing.

Press **Esc** or tap elsewhere to close it without going anywhere.

Restarting, Re-rolling and Starting Over (v1.92)

Three different tools, easy to confuse, so here is exactly what each one does:

Command	What it does	Use it when
Restart Encounter More > Restart Encounter	Keeps the same combatants **and their initiative**. Everyone returns to full health; conditions, temporary HP, death saves, legendary and lair uses, recharges, spell slots and X/Day abilities are all restored. The round goes back to 1 with no active turn.	You want to run the same fight again — testing an encounter, replaying after a wipe, or running it for a second group.
Roll Init	Re-rolls initiative only. Health, conditions and ability uses are left exactly as they are.	You just want a new turn order.
New Encounter More > New Encounter	Clears the board completely — every combatant is removed.	You are moving on to a different fight.

Restart asks for confirmation if there is anything to lose, and is undoable either way. Players marked absent stay absent — who turned up tonight isn't something the fight changed. A note is written to the combat log so the record shows where the second run began.

Rolling Initiative (v1.82)

Roll Init rolls for every monster, NPC and ally in the encounter — players keep their own rolls, and lair cards or timers keep their fixed count. Every roll is a d20 **plus that creature's own initiative bonus**, taken from its stat block (the *initiative bonus* field where the creature has one, otherwise its Dexterity modifier), so a nimble creature really does tend to go earlier.

Grouped or individual? By default, identical creatures share a single roll — five goblins all act on the same count, which is how most tables run a mob and keeps the turn order short. If you'd rather every creature rolled separately, switch it under **More > Initiative rolls**. The menu shows which mode you're in, and your choice is remembered between sessions. Both modes always add each creature's own bonus; the mode only decides whether they share the d20.

Re-rolling part of the encounter. Tick the combatants you want — or a whole group at once using its header checkbox — and the selection bar gives you two options:

- **Reroll** — re-rolls just those combatants, using whichever mode you're currently in. Everything else keeps its initiative.

- **Reroll Split** — re-rolls those combatants so that **each one gets its own value**, whatever your default is set to. This is the quick way to break up a group: if your goblins and your wolves both landed on 14, select the goblins, split them, and the tie resolves itself.

Both are undoable, so there's no risk in trying a roll you don't like.

Initiative Housekeeping (v1.73)

Three small things that save a lot of fiddling:

- **Fix a wrong initiative** — click the number in the circle on any card, type the correct value and press Enter. The list re-sorts immediately and the active turn stays with the same creature.
- **Break a tie your way** — combatants on the same initiative can be nudged with the (up) / (down) buttons on their cards, or dragged by the handle on the left edge. Ordering only moves within the tie.
- **Move a whole group** (v1.79) — when two monster groups roll the same initiative (five goblins and two wolves both on 14), the group header gets its own **ORDER (up) (down)** buttons at the right-hand end, which move that entire group above or below the other in one click. (They sit apart from the (down) collapse arrow on the left, which expands or hides the group's members.) The arrows on individual cards still work as before for nudging a single combatant within a tie.

Damage & Healing

Enter a number in the damage field. Press **Enter** or click **DMG**. Press **H** or click **HEAL**. Temp HP absorbed first — the log shows the whole hit and how much the temp HP soaked up. Mistakes? **Ctrl+Z**.

Damage Types — Optional (v1.115)

Damage is **untyped by default** and works exactly as it always has: the number you type is the damage dealt. You never have to choose a type. It's there for the moments it matters — when the creature you're hitting resists, ignores or is vulnerable to something.

- **Where it appears** — a small **Type >** button next to DMG, but **only** on creatures whose stat block lists damage immunities, resistances or vulnerabilities (the same creatures that show the Defenses pill). Everywhere else a type would change nothing, so there's no button.
- **Using it** — tap **Type >** and the picker lists *that creature's own* defences, grouped as **Immune** (no damage), **Resistant** (half, rounded down) and **Vulnerable** (double). Pick the one that matches the hit, type the damage, press DMG. The button shows what's armed — e.g. **Fire ×0**, **Cold ½**, **Fire ×2**.
- **One hit only** — the pick applies to the next damage on that creature, then the button goes back to **Type >**. A pick you don't use clears when the turn advances. Healing ignores it.
- **Order doesn't matter** — you can type the number first and pick the type after; the number stays in the box.
- **Conditional defences** — lines like "bludgeoning, piercing and slashing *from nonmagical attacks*" are shown with their condition in italics. Choosing one is your ruling that it applies to this hit.
- **What it changes** — the damage taken, the per-turn tally and the **concentration DC** all use the adjusted number. Immunity means no damage at all: temp HP isn't touched and no concentration check is asked for. The log records what happened, e.g. *"Ice Troll took 24 fire damage — vulnerable, 12 doubled"*.

> **Tip:** The button follows the linked stat block, so players normally don't get one — though a druid Wild Shaped into a beast with defences does, for as long as the form lasts. If a player has resistance (a raging barbarian, say), halve the number yourself as usual.

Concentration Checks (v1.117)

When a concentrating creature takes damage, a **Concentration Check** pops up with the Constitution save DC: 10 or half the damage taken (rounded down), whichever is higher. Mark it **Saved**, **Failed** (concentration ends and it's logged) or **Dismiss** it.

- **One attack, one save** — if you enter a hit in parts (slashing, then fire, because only the fire is resisted), the parts add up in the same check: *"took 15 + 7 = 22 damage"*, DC 11. Once you've marked the check, the next damage counts as a new hit with its own save. So for two separate attacks, resolve the first check before entering the second.
- **Nothing gets lost** — when one Fireball catches two concentrating casters, their checks queue up and appear one after the other (the popup shows who's next).
- **New turn, new hit** — damage entered after the turn advances always starts a fresh check, even if an old one is still open.
- **2014 or 2024** — under the 2024 rules the DC is capped at 30. The tracker follows the 2014 / 2024 toggle in **Party & XP**, which is now remembered between sessions.

Finding the Active Turn (v1.62)

The active combatant's card is now unmissable: a pulsing gold **chevron** sits on its left edge, the card carries a double gold ring, and its initiative circle inverts to a solid gold disc with a larger number. Everything uses your chosen theme's accent colour, in both light and night mode, and the pulse is automatically disabled if your device requests reduced motion. Best of all: if you've scrolled away, **click the current combatant's name in the turn banner** (or the collapsed combat bar) and the tracker scrolls you straight back to the active card.

Hiding Defeated Combatants (v1.60)

In long fights the list fills up with the fallen. When at least one combatant is defeated, an eye pill appears in the header stats row — **3 defeated**. Click it (or press **H**) to hide all defeated combatants; the pill switches to **3 defeated (hidden)** and clicking or pressing H again brings them back. This is display-only: the turn order, the log, and all data are untouched, and the combatant whose turn it currently is always stays visible even if defeated. The setting is remembered between sessions.

Lair Actions on the Card (v1.55)

A creature whose stat block includes Lair Actions gets a gold **LAIR** pip on its combat card, right beside the legendary pips. It's a once-per-round reminder: lair actions fire on initiative count 20 (losing ties). Click the pip when the lair acts — it resets automatically when a new round begins. **Or give the lair its own card (v1.56):** open the creature's stat block and click **Add Lair to Initiative**. The lair joins the order as its own combatant at initiative 20 (correctly losing ties), with the lair actions as its actions and the regional effects on its stat block — its turn coming round is your once-per-round cue, so the source creature's LAIR pip retires. Roll Initiative leaves it fixed at 20. And it's fully reusable (v1.59): in any later encounter, adding the same creature brings the button (and the pip) back automatically — click it and the lair rejoins the new fight, reusing its saved stat block with nothing duplicated.

Editing HP & Max HP (v1.48)

Click a card's **HP display** (the X/Y value) to edit. You can now set **both** current and maximum HP — handy for splitting creatures like an Ochre Jelly (halve both numbers on the original, then 1 a copy and do the same). For combatants linked to a database or custom monster, quick **Avg / Max / Roll** buttons fill the max from the creature's hit dice — the same choices you get when adding. When you change the max, the **“Adjust current HP by the change”** tickbox (on by default) carries the difference into current HP — and you see the result **live in the current-HP field before you press Set**: raising an average-HP monster to maximum mid-fight heals it by the difference, dropping it back down removes the same amount, and unticking the box means current HP is left alone entirely — the one exception is that if you drop the max below the current value, current is capped at the new max when you press Set (5e doesn’t allow current above max), with a log entry saying so. If you type your own current value, the preview steps aside and respects it. Leaving the current-HP field blank leaves current HP unchanged.

Conditions

Click Conditions on any card. Click a condition to apply/remove. Set optional duration for auto-expiry. Tags pulse amber at 1 round remaining. Each badge shows a unique SVG icon.

28 conditions — alphabetical: Blinded, Burning, Charmed, Deafened, Dodging, Exhausted, Frightened, Grappled, Hasted, Hiding, Incapacitated, Invisible, Intoxicated, Marked, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned, Prone, Raging, Restrained, Silenced, Slowed, Stunned, Surprised, Unconscious — with Advantage, Disadvantage and Other at the end.

Rule reminders: tap the on any condition pill for a short reminder of what it does. Conditions whose rules changed between editions (Exhausted, Grappled, Incapacitated, Invisible, Surprised) show 2014 / 2024 pills you can switch between; the edition shown first follows the creature's own edition where known, otherwise the ruleset selected in the XP calculator. Non-standard markers (e.g. Burning, Raging) are flagged as suggested reminders rather than official rules.

Other lets you add a custom marker: pick it and type a short label (max 32 characters), which then shows on the pill — handy for one-off effects the list doesn't cover.

Exhaustion is a special case — clicking it asks for a level (1–5). The badge shows "Exhausted Lv3". The level never auto-decrements; click the badge to edit.

Death Saves

Pip shapes: empty = circle · success filled = green heart · failure filled = red skull. Dead cards keep all 3 skulls visible.

Roll	Action	Result
10+	Click heart pip	One success
1-9	Click skull pip	One failure
Natural 1	Click Nat 1	Two failures at once
Natural 20	Click Nat 20	HP=1, wakes up, Unconscious cleared

3 successes > Stable: no more death save prompts. Damage while stable resumes saves (2014 + 2024 rules). 3 failures > Dead + Revive button.

Revivify countdown: after 3 failures, a countdown shows rounds remaining before Revivify is no longer viable (10 rounds = 1 minute). Pulses red in last 3 rounds. Shown in red bold when expired.

Boss DS: click DS button on any monster card to enable death saves instead of instant death at 0 HP.

Wild Shape / Transformation

Click on any card. Monster DB opens in transform mode. Search new form and click Transform. HP and AC swap. Click Revert to restore original stats.

Status Strip & Ability Tracking

Each card shows a status strip below the HP bar:

Element	How to use
Reaction	Click to mark used (fades). Auto-resets next turn.
LEG pips	Click to mark legendary action used. Resets on monster turn.
Recharge tag	Click to expend. Flashes red at turn start as roll reminder.
Ready	Shows trigger text (up to 64 chars). Auto-clears at start of that combatant's next turn. Click to clear early.
Spell slots	Click to expend slot at that level. Any level — DM chooses.
Innate spells	Click pip per use. At-will spells labelled only.
X/Day	Amber pips. Click to expend, click again to restore.
Reset Uses	Restores all slots, innate, X/Day, recharge, legendary in one click.

Start/End of turn (v1.34)	Appears on creatures whose stat block has a start- or end-of-turn ability (e.g. Troll regeneration). Pulses during that creature's turn as a reminder. Hover for the ability name; for regeneration it notes the suppression condition (e.g. "took acid/fire"). Advisory only — separate from Recharge, and the DM resolves it. Damage type isn't tracked, so confirm against the stat block.

Per-Turn Damage Tally (v1.34)

When a combatant takes damage, a small red **pill** appears to the left of its damage box showing the **total damage taken so far this turn**. It helps you track abilities that trigger on a damage threshold without adding up the numbers yourself.

- **Counts damage only** — healing does not reduce it. It tallies the damage the creature takes, including any soaked up by temporary HP. With a damage type picked, it counts the amount after resistance or immunity.
- **Resets every time the turn advances** — the pill clears and disappears.
- **Every damage path counts** — the card's damage box and the bulk DMG / ½ DMG actions all feed it.
- **Undo-aware** — undo rolls the tally back in step, including across turn changes.

The pill changes to flag thresholds, as an **advisory reminder** (never an automatic effect):

Pill	Meaning
Plain red	Running total of damage taken this turn.
Pulsing red	Reached a threshold parsed from the stat block, e.g. a hydra's "25+ damage in one turn". Hover to see the trait; confirm the damage type if the trait is type-specific.
Bright pulsing red	Damage this turn reached the creature's **maximum HP** — the massive-damage instant-death rule may apply.
Amber	**Big Hit!** — over 50 damage in a turn. A purely informational "heavy blow" marker, not a rules trigger. The also appears on the red/threshold pills above whenever a turn passes 50, so a big hit is always flagged even when a rules threshold owns the colour.

> **Tip:** These reminders are aids — they flag when a number is reached and point you to the stat block, but you always resolve the effect yourself.

Combat Reminder Pills (v1.35)

Monster cards now show small **reminder pills** for things that are easy to forget mid-fight. They're read-only: tap one to see the detail in a popover (on a tablet or phone this opens as a bottom sheet, so it always works on touch), then check the stat block to resolve.

Pill	Shows
Defenses	Damage resistances, immunities, condition immunities, and vulnerabilities. The pill turns amber when the creature has a vulnerability, and the popover highlights vulnerabilities (the exploitable "takes extra" damage) so you don't miss them. To apply one to a hit, use the optional **Type >** button next to DMG (see *Damage Types*).
Traits	The forgettable combat traits: **Multiattack**, **Magic Resistance** (advantage on saves vs spells), and **Pack Tactics**. Tap for the trait text.
Start/End of turn	As before — start- or end-of-turn abilities such as regeneration. Now tappable too, so its detail works on touch.

These appear only on creatures whose stat block has the relevant feature, so a plain combatant stays uncluttered. Legendary Resistance isn't a pill — it's already tracked by its own Per Day counter. Recharge stays its own separate tracker.

Group Management & Bulk Actions

Tick 2+ checkboxes to show the bulk action bar. **DMG All** (full damage), **Heal All**, **½ DMG** (half damage, rounded down, for successful saves). Each is a single undo step.

Fireball example: 8 goblins hit for 28. 6 fail the save, 2 succeed. Select the **6 who failed** > type 28 > DMG All. Then select only the **2 who saved** > ½ DMG (they take 14). Done in seconds. *(Don't include the savers in the first step — that would give them full damage plus the half.)*

Damage type for the group (v1.115) — optional, next to the amount box. Leave it on **Untyped** and nothing changes. Choose a type and each selected creature applies *its own* stat block: in one Fireball the fire elemental takes nothing, the resistant devil takes half and the goblins take it in full. The choice stays set for both DMG All and ½ DMG (so the failed-then-saved routine needs choosing once) and resets when the turn advances. Conditional defences ("from nonmagical attacks", "damage from spells") are **never** applied automatically here — the log notes them so you can adjust by hand if they apply.

> **Tip:** Use +1 button on any monster card to add a reinforcement of the same type mid-combat.

Other Combatant Type

For lair actions, hazards, traps, ritual timers, reinforcements — anything needing a turn slot that isn't a creature. Teal styling. Excluded from XP and Alive counts.

An **Other** combatant is a full card, not a cut-down one: it has AC, hit points, damage and healing, conditions and notes, exactly like a monster. That means it covers three quite different jobs:

- **Something to destroy** (v1.100) — a barred door, a barricade, a siege engine, a crystal the villain is channelling through. Give it an AC and hit points and the party can attack it like anything else: damage applies normally, the HP bar drains, and when it reaches 0 the card greys out as destroyed rather than disappearing, so you can still see what was there. Because it is an Other, smashing it awards no XP and doesn't count as a casualty.
- **An environmental effect** — an avalanche, a collapsing ceiling, rising water, a spreading fire. Leave the hit points at zero; the card exists purely to claim a place in the turn order so the effect happens at the right moment each round. Put the save DC and damage in the notes field and read it straight off the card.
- **A timer** — a ritual completing in three rounds, reinforcements arriving on round four, a portal closing. Set the initiative where you want it to fire and use the notes to say what happens.

One important difference: Other combatants are the only type **Roll Init leaves alone**. Whatever count you give them, they keep it — so an avalanche pinned to initiative 20 stays on 20 every round instead of being re-rolled. That is what makes them reliable for anything that should happen at a fixed point in the round.

If an object is genuinely a creature in disguise — an animated armour, say, or a swarm — add it as a **Monster** instead, so it rolls initiative and counts toward the encounter's XP.

Type	Initiative	Notes field
Lair Action	20	Dragon exhales fumes — DC 13 CON save or Poisoned.
Avalanche	20 and 10	DC 15 DEX save. Fail: 4d10+prone. Success: half.
Trap	15	Swinging blade: DC 14 DEX or 2d10 slashing.
Barred Door	0	AC 15, 27 HP. Destructible — damage it like a creature.

Reinforcements	12	Goblin patrol arrives Round 4. Add 6 goblins.

Monster Groups ()

Pre-build named sets of monsters and drop the whole group into any encounter with one click — ideal for reinforcements, lair defenders, and frequently-used combinations.

Creating a group: Monster DB > Groups tab > New Group. Name your group, search for monsters, set quantities, save.

Using a group: Each group card has Add to Encounter (drops all monsters at once, undo-safe), Edit, and Delete.

Add as Monster or Ally (v1.42): above the group list, the same **Add as Monster / Add as Ally** toggle you know from the search tab now appears here too. Pick a side, then Add to Encounter — the whole group joins as monsters or as allies. It's a runtime choice: nothing is saved into the group itself, so the same saved group can be enemies in one fight and reinforcements in the next. The toggle is shared with the search tab — switching it in either place updates both.

Split layout: When adding monsters to a group, click any search result name to open a stat block preview on the right. The panel widens so you can browse and read simultaneously.

Export / Import: Export saves all groups as JSON. Import restores them on any device.

PART 3 — ADVANCED & REFERENCE (prep, homebrew, portability, customisation)

Monster Database & Custom Content

Click Monster DB. ~3,500 monsters plus the full spell list — both the **2014 (SRD 5.1)** and **2024 (SRD 5.2)** rules — cached offline. Panel stays open — add multiple monsters, toast confirms each.

Split layout (v1.17): Click any monster name to open its stat block on the right while the search list stays visible on the left. The panel widens automatically. Click in the stat block header to close and return to full search. On a phone (v1.117) there isn't room for both, so the stat block fills the panel and **Close stat block** takes you back to the results (the Spell Library works the same way).

Looking for a mini? (v1.116): at the very foot of each stat block here, one small line searches the MitzNSimz miniatures shop for that creature (it opens in a new tab). It appears only in the Monster DB, while you're browsing or prepping — never on combatant cards, in the combat stat block, or while picking a Wild Shape form — and it disappears once you've added a photo of your own painted mini. Custom monsters search by their optional **Mini search term** (in the editor, under Description), or by their creature type if that's blank: homebrew names rarely match a product, but "undead" or "aberration" search well. Cloning a database monster fills the term in with the original's name. To hide it: **More > Mini Shop Links: Off**.

Source badge: Each search result shows the ruleset source (e.g. 5e 2014 Rules, 5e 2024 Rules, A5E) — useful when multiple versions of the same monster exist.

Source filter (v1.31): Next to the All / Official / Custom buttons, the **Sources >** dropdown lets you limit the list to specific source books — tick as many as you like (e.g. only the SRD, or only your Kobold Press titles), and "All sources" clears the selection. It only lists books actually present in your database, combines with the All/Official/Custom filter and the search box, and your choice is remembered between sessions.

Advanced filters (v1.36): The **Filters** button opens a panel to narrow the list by **Type** (Beast, Dragon, Undead…), **Size** (Tiny–Gargantuan) and **Challenge Rating** (a min–max range). Tap chips to toggle them; the button shows a count of active filters. Everything combines — type, size, CR, the source filter, the All/Official/Custom buttons and the search box all apply together — so you can ask for, say, "Large dragons of CR 5–10" in a couple of taps. The type and size chips only show values that exist in your database. **Clear all** resets them.

Parse Block: paste any stat block — D&D Beyond, PDF, Homebrewery, plain text, or **Tetra-cube Markdown** — into the parser, or paste a **Tetra-cube** `.monster` **JSON**. You can also click **File** to load a `.monster`, `.json`, `.md` or `.txt` file directly. > preview > Open in Editor > Save.

Always check what the parser guessed (v1.75): parsing is a time-saving starting point, not a guarantee. Stat blocks copied from PDFs and websites arrive with broken columns, lost line breaks and stray punctuation, and the parser has to infer structure from that. Before you save, review **AC, HP and hit dice, attack bonuses and damage, recharge text, legendary actions and lair actions** in the preview or the editor — these create real game mechanics at the table, and a misread number is easier to fix now than mid-combat.

How the parser reads ability names (v1.113)

Within Traits, Actions, Bonus Actions, Reactions and Legendary Actions, the parser has to work out where each ability's *name* ends and its description begins. Published stat blocks always put a full stop after the name, but homebrew varies, so the following are all understood:

Written as	Example
Full stop	Multiattack. The beast makes two attacks.
Exclamation or question mark	All Hands, You Bastards! Bluemoon shouts an order.
Colon	All Hands: Bluemoon shouts an order.
Dash, with spaces around it	All Hands — Bluemoon shouts an order.
Markdown bold	**All Hands.** Bluemoon shouts an order.
Name on its own line	All Hands Bluemoon shouts an order.

Hyphenated names such as Hit-and-Run and recharge ranges such as (Recharge 5–6) are safe, because a dash only separates a name from its description when it has spaces on both sides.

The one form that cannot be read is a name with no punctuation after it at all — All Hands Bluemoon shouts an order. There is genuinely no way to tell where the name stops and the sentence starts, so the tracker leaves it rather than guessing. If a block is written that way, add a full stop or a colon after each ability name before pasting.

If a whole section comes out empty — no Bonus Actions, say, when the block clearly has some — that is nearly always the cause: the names are formatted in a way the parser can't split. The section heading itself (*Bonus Actions*, *Reactions*, *Legendary Actions*) is recognised on its own, in singular or plural. Adding a full stop after each ability name and pasting again will usually fix it, and you can always add the missing entries by hand in the editor afterwards.

Tetra-cube import (v1.26): For `.monster` JSON the parser computes Armor Class from the armour fields and resolves Tetra-cube expressions automatically — attack bonuses (`[STR ATK]`), damage (`[DEX 2D8]`), save DCs (`[WIS SAVE]`) and name tokens (`[MON]`). Try the **Tetra JSON** example button next to Goblin / Dragon. The Markdown export is the most robust route, as its values are already resolved.

Parse Spell: Open Spell Library > Parse Spell. Paste any spell stat block (2014 or 2024 format). All fields extracted automatically.

Spell split view (v1.17): Click any spell to open its full stat block on the right — level, school, casting time, range, duration, components, description, source, and At Higher Levels. **Source pills (v1.23):** when a spell exists in more than one ruleset, a pill appears per source (e.g. 2014 / 2024) — tap to switch between versions. Opened from a creature, the sheet defaults to the version matching that creature. Clone to Custom creates an editable copy.

Spell filters (v1.36): The Spell Library has its own **Filters** panel: filter by **Level** (Cantrip–9), **School** (the eight schools), **Class** (which class can cast it), and the **Concentration** and **Ritual** flags. Chips toggle on tap and all combine with each other and the search box. A few spells from the Adventurer's Guide list no class; where the same spell exists elsewhere with class data the library fills it in automatically and merges the duplicate, and a **(no class)** chip catches any that remain so nothing is ever hidden by the class filter.

> **Tip:** The tracker supports official, third-party, and fully homebrewed content equally well.

Encounter Tools

Party Configurations

Save your party once: Party & XP > Save Party. Each session: Parties > Add to Encounter — players load at full HP. Player portraits are saved with the party and travel with it.

Renamed (v1.38): the toolbar button previously called **XP Calc** is now **Party & XP**, since party save/load is its most-used feature. Same panel — party setup, XP & difficulty, and the random encounter generator all still live here.

Updating a saved party (v1.31): Load a party, adjust levels, names or portraits in the calculator, then click **Update** on that party's row to overwrite it in place — no more duplicate copies. Load, Update, Add to Encounter and Delete each sit on the party's row.

Backup & transfer (v1.31): Use **Export** to save all your parties to a JSON file, and **Import** to load them on another device (duplicates by name are skipped). This matches the Export/Import already available for custom monsters, custom spells, monster groups and encounters.

Adding Several Monsters at Once (v1.73)

When adding from the Monster Database, set the **quantity** before clicking Add and the tracker creates numbered siblings (Goblin 1, Goblin 2…) that automatically collapse into one group header — one line in the list instead of eight. Need one more mid-fight? The **+1** button on any card duplicates that creature, rolling it into the same group. Click a group header to expand or collapse its members.

Moving Encounters Between Devices (v1.73)

Everything lives in this browser only, so moving between machines is a deliberate export/import:

- **A single encounter** — **More > Quick Save** downloads the current fight as a file you can carry anywhere; **Quick Load** reads it back on the other device. Your whole Encounters library travels as one file with **Encounters > Export All** and **Import**.
- **Everything you have made** — **More > Full Backup (All Custom Data)** exports your custom monsters and spells, party configurations and saved encounters in one file. Import it on the new device to restore the lot.
- **The monster database itself** doesn't travel — it re-downloads on first use. **Refresh Database** updates it on demand, and if you're offline the tracker refuses the refresh rather than clearing what you already have.

Encounter Library

Encounters > Save Current Encounter at any point stores the fight in this browser under a name. Next session, open **Encounters** and load it to resume exactly — HP, conditions, round and whose turn it is. For mid-dungeon continuity across sessions.

More > Quick Save is different: it downloads the fight as a file rather than adding it to the library — handy for moving it to another device (**Quick Load** reads it back).

XP & Difficulty

Party & XP shows Easy/Medium/Hard/Deadly in real time as monsters die. Toggle between 2014 and 2024 rules — your choice is remembered (v1.117), and it also sets which edition's rule reminders show first and whether the concentration DC is capped at 30 (2024).

Random Encounter Generator

A word on what this is for: the generator is a bit of cheeky fun — a way to break the deadlock when you can't decide what to throw at the party, or when they wander somewhere you hadn't prepped. Roll it, and either run

what comes out or let it spark something better of your own. It knows the XP maths and it knows which creatures live where, but it doesn't know your story: it will happily suggest something that makes no sense in your dungeon, and swapping a creature or two is expected rather than a sign anything went wrong. Treat it as a prompt, not a ruling — you're still the DM.

Set difficulty, type (Horde/Skirmish/Boss/Boss+Minions), environment. Generate. Reroll. Add All in one click.

Difficulty you can trust (v1.65): the XP budget is computed from your **current party** (the Party & XP roster — set it up for accurate results; without one, four level-5 characters are assumed), using the official rules for your chosen ruleset: 2014 thresholds with the encounter multiplier (including the party-size adjustment), or 2024 XP budgets, which correctly use *no* multiplier. Every generated encounter is verified to actually land in the requested difficulty band before it's shown, and the result is labelled by what was really built — in the rare case the monster pool can't hit the band (e.g. a heavily filtered source list), the label says so honestly rather than pretending.

Environment filter (v1.67): the Environment dropdown is built from the monster database itself — it lists the environment tags actually present in your cached data, with monster counts (e.g. "Forest (214)"), so a choice always matches real monsters. Open5e provides these tags per creature; they join the local cache with this version, so the tracker will re-download the database once, automatically. If your chosen environment has no monsters within your selected source books, the generator says so honestly and draws from all environments instead.

Smarter Boss + Minions (v1.68): minions are chosen by affinity with the boss — first by **name family** (a Hobgoblin Captain leads Hobgoblins), then by **creature type** (undead lead undead), and only then by pure numbers, so the pairing is thematic whenever your monster pool allows and generation never fails when it doesn't. Sometimes the retinue mixes **two minion kinds** from the same family for variety. Retinues are built **size-first (v1.71)** — a boss plus roughly 2–6 minions, with the boss taking about half the budget — so you always get a proper entourage rather than a lone bodyguard, and hordes occasionally mix in a same-family companion. The difficulty maths is unchanged and still verified.

Your party is remembered (v1.71): the Party & XP roster now persists between sessions, so the generator always budgets for your real party. Previously it reverted to a default four level-5 characters after a reload until you reopened Party & XP — which quietly made generated encounters too soft for a higher-level party.

Source filter (v1.31): The generator has its own **Sources >** dropdown (independent of the Monster DB browser filter) so you can roll encounters from only the books you choose — e.g. SRD-only, or a single bestiary. Your generator source choice is remembered separately from the browser filter.

Turn Timer (Optional)

Enable via More > Turn Timer. Countdown appears on active card: green (>50%) > amber > red > flashing red (last 5s).

Group	Suggested duration
Experienced players	45 seconds
Typical group	60 seconds
Newer players	90 seconds

On expiry: popup with Next Turn (advances immediately) or Stay. Pause freely for rules questions — it's a pacing tool, not a strict rule.

Session Summary (v1.40)

Turn your combat log into a plain-text recap you can keep or share. It lists the current combatants and their HP, how many rounds were fought, and the full combat log grouped by round with timestamps.

Any time: More > **Session Summary** downloads the recap as a `.txt` file.

When starting a New Encounter: if there's combat activity worth keeping, the confirmation offers an **Export Summary First** option — take it to save a record before the encounter is cleared, then carry on. If you don't want it, just start the new encounter as normal. It never forces you.

How the combat log is stored (v1.45): the log is saved in your browser together with the encounter, so an accidental page refresh (or closing and reopening the tab) no longer wipes it — your log picks up right where it was. It is cleared when you start a **New Encounter**, and it keeps the most recent 2,000 entries (roughly 95 full rounds of a ten-combatant battle — far more than any real session), silently dropping only the oldest beyond that. **Recommendation:** the in-browser log is working state, not an archive — for a permanent record of a session, export a **Session Summary**; that file lives on your device and survives anything the browser does. Both exports carry timing (v1.53): the Session Summary stamps each entry [HH:MM], and the Log panel offers a family of exports: **.txt** (raw line-per-event with full [HH:MM:SS] timestamps), **.md** (Markdown with a heading per round — pastes straight into Obsidian or any notes app), **.json** (raw entries for scripts and tools), and **AI Recap**, which copies the log plus a ready-made prompt to your clipboard — paste it into your AI assistant of choice and get a narrative write-up of the battle.

Appearance & Accessibility

Open the **More** menu to tailor how the tracker looks. These settings are remembered between sessions and are stored only on your device.

About (v1.41): at the bottom of the **More** menu, **About** re-opens the welcome splash you saw on first launch — a quick reminder of what the tracker is and the design principles behind it.

Day & Night

Use the **Day / Night** toggle in the header to switch between light and dark bases. On first open the tracker follows your device's own light/dark setting; once you pick a side manually, your choice is remembered and always wins.

Accent Colour

Choose from six accent colours — **Gold** (the classic), **Red**, **Blue**, **Green**, **Purple** and **Silver** — from the swatch row in the More menu. The accent recolours headings, links, buttons, the active-turn highlight and the player initials chips all at once. It applies in **both Day and Night**, so you can switch base freely and keep your colour. Tapping a swatch leaves the menu open, so you can flick between colours and compare. Health bars always stay green/amber/red regardless of accent — health colour means health, never decoration.

Legible Font

The **Legible Font** toggle in the More menu swaps the decorative display type for a clean system sans-serif on the highest-traffic text — names, headers, menu items and badges. Useful in low light or for faster reading at a glance. Like the accent swatches, the toggle leaves the menu open so you can compare on and off instantly.

Device Accessibility Settings

The tracker respects your operating system's accessibility preferences: if you have **reduce motion** enabled, animations are calmed throughout; if your system is set to a light appearance, the tracker opens in Day mode to match. Base text scales with your browser's text-size / zoom, so increasing the font size behaves as expected.

Tablet & Phone Input (v1.33)

Number fields — damage, HP, AC, initiative, counts and ability scores — request the **numeric keypad** on tablets and phones, so entering values during combat is quick. To dismiss the on-screen keyboard, tap anywhere outside the field (or use your keyboard's *Done* / down button). The damage field keeps focus after you apply, so you can damage several creatures in a row; tap away when you're finished to close the keyboard.

Photos of Your Painted Minis (v1.77)

If you paint miniatures, you can attach a photo of the real thing to any monster. Open a monster's stat block and choose **Add mini photo**: the picture appears large in the stat block, and as a thumbnail on that creature's combatant card during combat, so the table sees your actual mini rather than a generic card. Monsters you have photographed show a small in the Monster Database list.

- **Where they live** — in your browser, in their own storage area. A **Refresh Database** never touches them, and because they are linked to the monster rather than to one encounter, the photo comes back every time you use that creature.
- **How many** — up to 300 photos (about 20 MB). Nothing is ever deleted automatically: at around 80% you get a heads-up, and if you reach the limit the tracker asks you to remove a few rather than quietly dropping one. **More > Manage Mini Photos** shows everything you have stored, what it is costing, and lets you remove any of them.
- **Photographing** — any PNG, JPEG or WebP up to 12 MB. The tracker crops it square, shrinks it and stores only that small copy; your original photo is never uploaded or kept. Pictures taken on a phone keep the right way up.
- **Backups** — mini photos are included in **Full Backup**, so they travel with everything else. Restoring with *Merge* keeps the photos you already have; *Clear & Replace* swaps in the ones from the file.

Player Portraits

You can give a player a **portrait** in the XP / party panel: use the avatar control on that player's row to pick an image. It then appears as a small rounded thumbnail on the left of that combatant's card during combat. Players without a portrait show a tidy **initials chip** instead (which follows your accent colour). Portraits are handled privately and efficiently — the image is shrunk to a small thumbnail in your own browser and only that compact version is stored; the original file is never kept or uploaded, and nothing leaves your device. Portraits travel with their party through Export / Import and Quick Save / Load.

Keyboard Shortcuts

Key	Action
N	Next Turn
Space	Pause / Resume turn timer (when timer is active)
/	Open Monster DB and focus search field
S	Show / hide the active combatant's stat block (if it has one) (v1.33)
Esc	Close any open panel
Enter	Apply damage (when field focused)
H	Apply as healing (when field focused)
Ctrl+Z	Undo last action (up to 20 steps)

Frequently Asked Questions

How do I resolve initiative ties?

Grab the grip icon on the left edge of any card and drag it above or below the other. Initiative values are never changed by dragging.

How do I apply AoE damage to multiple targets?

Tick checkboxes > bulk bar appears > enter damage > **DMG All** (full) or **½ DMG** (half, for saves). Fireball example: select the targets who **failed** the save, DMG All; then select only those who **saved**, ½ DMG. Optionally set the damage type first and each creature's resistances and immunities apply (see *Group Management & Bulk Actions*).

How do I set HP for a monster?

Click **HP >** on any card to open the HP mode popup: **Average HP**, **Maximum HP**, **Roll Dice**, or **Set Value** (enter any number). The Monster DB also offers these modes before adding. In the bulk action bar, Set Max HP opens the same popup — dice modes available when at least one selected combatant has a stat block.

I made a mistake — how do I fix it?

Ctrl+Z / Cmd+Z or Undo. Restores full state — HP, conditions, active turn, round — up to 20 steps back. Every state change is tracked including HP edits, AC/initiative edits, condition changes, and notes. The Undo button shows a gold count badge indicating steps remaining. **New Encounter is undoable too (v1.66):** if you clear the field by accident, Undo brings the whole encounter back — combatants, round, and turn. The one thing that starts fresh is the combat log, so export a session summary first if you want a permanent record.

On my phone the header and toolbar disappear when I start combat — is that normal?

Yes (v1.37). On phones and small tablets, the tracker collapses the header and toolbar into a slim bar once combat begins (and whenever you scroll down the list), so the combatant list gets nearly the whole screen. The slim bar still shows the round, whose turn it is, and a **Next** button. It deliberately **stays** collapsed while you scroll up and down — so it won't flicker in and out as you scan a long combat. To bring the full header and footer back, tap the small **chevron** on the left of the slim bar (or the chevron next to **? Help**). On desktop and wide tablets the header always stays put.

It's a **reminder only** — it flags that a creature's stat block contains a start- or end-of-turn ability (regeneration, an aura, ongoing damage, a recharge-on-turn effect, and so on) and pulses during that creature's turn. It does **not** resolve anything, and deliberately so. One subtlety worth knowing: a "start/end of turn" effect might trigger on **this creature's own turn** (e.g. a troll regaining HP) **or on another combatant's turn** (e.g. an aura that damages anyone who starts their turn near it). The pill can't know which — it just makes sure you don't forget the effect exists. Tap it, read the ability, check the stat block, and resolve it yourself. If you realise you missed it on an earlier turn, you can apply it retroactively or use Undo to step back to that combatant and resolve it there.

How long does the tracker keep my data, and can a browser delete it?

Your encounters, parties, custom monsters, mini photos and settings live in your browser's storage on the device you use. Nothing is sent anywhere and there is no account, which is why it works offline — but it also means the browser, not the tracker, ultimately decides how long that data survives. The rules differ significantly, and one of them catches people out.

Browser	How long your data lasts
Chrome, Edge including Chromebooks	Kept indefinitely. It goes only if you clear browsing data with "cookies and other site data" ticked, use a different browser profile or device, or the device runs very low on disk space.
Safari Mac, iPad, iPhone	**Deleted after seven days without using the tracker.** Safari removes stored data for any site you haven't interacted with in about a week of browser use. Visiting the tracker resets the clock, so regular play is fine — but a gap between sessions can clear everything.
Firefox	Kept indefinitely, unless you have set it to clear cookies and site data when it closes, or you browse in a private window.

If you use Safari, this is worth acting on. Two things protect you:

- **Add the tracker to your Home Screen** (Share > Add to Home Screen) on an iPad or iPhone. Apps launched that way are exempt from the seven-day rule, and you get a full-screen app into the bargain.
- **On an Android tablet or phone** you can install the tracker the same way (Chrome menu > *Add to Home screen* or *Install app*), but it is **not needed to protect your data** — Android's Chrome has no seven-day rule. Do it if you simply prefer a full-screen app with its own icon.
- **Take a Full Backup** (More > Full Backup) after any session you would mind repeating. It saves one file containing everything — encounters, parties, custom monsters and mini photos — which you can restore on

any device or browser.

The tracker will also give you a gentle nudge: if you have encounters, parties, custom monsters or mini photos saved and haven't taken a backup for a while, a small amber reminder appears among the counters at the top. Tapping it takes a backup; tapping its hides it for a week. It appears sooner in Safari than elsewhere, for the reason above. If you have nothing saved yet, it never appears at all.

A Full Backup is worth taking periodically whichever browser you use. It is the only copy that is genuinely yours rather than the browser's, and it is the simplest way to move your material to a new computer, phone or tablet.

I saved the tracker to my computer — why did my encounters disappear?

Almost certainly because the file was renamed or moved. Your encounters, parties, custom monsters and settings are stored by your **browser**, not inside the tracker file, and the browser decides which store to use based on *where the page was opened from*.

When you open the tracker from a web address, that address is the same every time, so your data is always there. When you open it as a file on your computer, **Safari and Firefox treat every file as a separate place** — so tracker.html and tracker-v2.html each get their own, entirely separate set of saved encounters. Chrome and Edge share one store across local files, so you may not see this at all in those browsers.

If you run the tracker from a file, the rule is simple: when you update to a newer version, **overwrite the existing file, keeping the same name and folder**. Don't save the new version alongside the old one under a different name.

Before you change anything, take a **Full Backup** (More > Full Backup). If data does go missing this way it isn't lost — it is still attached to the old file, so putting that file back where it was will bring it back, and you can then export a backup and restore it into the new one.

The same applies to moving the file to a different folder, or to a USB stick: to the browser that is a different place, with a different store.

Chrome, Edge and Chromebooks behave the other way round, and it is worth knowing which way you are affected. They treat *every* local file as the same place, so renaming or moving a downloaded copy makes no difference — your encounters simply follow. The catch is the reverse of the problem above: if you keep **two** copies of the tracker on the same computer, an old download and a new one, they share a single set of saved encounters. Opening the older copy and saving will overwrite what you did in the newer one, because as far as the browser is concerned they are the same tracker.

So on those browsers the advice is simply: **keep one copy** and delete old downloads, rather than letting several versions accumulate in your Downloads folder.

On my iPad everything looks slightly small — can I make it bigger?

Yes, and it's a Safari setting rather than anything in the tracker. On iPads, Safari loads most sites in **desktop mode**, which lays the page out as though the screen were wider than it really is and then shrinks the result to fit. You get more on screen — which many DMs prefer — but text and buttons end up smaller than intended. Two ways to change it, both of which the tracker fully supports:

- **Tap in Safari's address bar > Request Mobile Website.** Safari remembers this for the tracker specifically, so you only do it once. Everything becomes larger, with bigger touch targets.
- **Add the tracker to your Home Screen** (Share > Add to Home Screen). It then opens full-screen like an app, at the proper size, without Safari's address bar taking up room.

Either way, nothing is lost — your encounters, custom monsters and settings are the same. If you prefer seeing more combatants at once, simply leave it as it is; the layout adapts to whatever space it has.

How can I remember an ongoing effect on a player (e.g. recurring damage)?

Add the **Other** condition (end of the condition list) to that combatant with a short label like "Burning 1d6/turn", and put the details in the card's **note** field. The labelled pill is a visible at-a-glance reminder each round, and the note carries the specifics. This is the simplest way to track a custom recurring effect on a player or monster — the tracker reminds you it's there; you decide when and how it applies.

How do I track a transformed or polymorphed combatant?

Click on the card. Monster DB opens in transform mode — search the new form, click Transform. HP and AC swap. Click Revert to restore original stats.

How do I apply death saves to a boss monster?

Click DS on the monster card. It turns solid red — the monster shows death save pips at 0 HP instead of dying instantly. Clicking it on a dead monster un-dies it retroactively.

What is the Revivify countdown?

After a character dies via 3 failed death saves, a countdown shows rounds remaining before Revivify is no longer viable (10 rounds = 1 minute). Pulses red in last 3 rounds. Red bold when expired.

A player is absent tonight — how do I handle it?

Click the button in the button row at the bottom of that player's card. The card dims, shows an *absent* badge, and that player is skipped when you press Next Turn — but they still count toward your party size for XP and difficulty. Click **Absent** again when they turn up late.

How do I get a log of the encounter?

Click Log. All meaningful events are captured automatically — damage, conditions, reactions, spell slots, group drops, per-turn entries, timer expiry, undo diffs, HP changes, initiative changes, AC changes, notes, death save tracking, and legendary action use. Add DM notes at the bottom. Export for a .txt session summary. The log resets on new encounter or when loading a saved encounter.

How do I save and resume mid-dungeon?

Encounters > Save Current Encounter. Next session: **Encounters** > pick it from the list. Everything resumes exactly — HP, conditions, round, active turn. To carry it to another device instead, use **More > Quick Save** (it downloads a file) and **Quick Load** on the other machine.

What is the difference between a Party Config and an Encounter save?

Party Config: saves the player roster at full HP — use to start each session fresh. **Encounter save:** saves complete combat state including current HP and conditions — use to pause mid-fight or continue next session.

How do I tell if my encounter is too deadly?

Party & XP shows the difficulty rating (Easy/Medium/Hard/Deadly) in real time as monsters die. Dead monsters remain in the XP total with a strikethrough — the full encounter XP is always shown. Toggle between 2014 and 2024 rules at the top.

How do I back up my custom monsters and spells?

Custom Monsters: + Custom Monster > Export. Custom Spells: Spell Library > Export Spells. Re-import on any device with the matching Import buttons.

Will my data sync between devices?

No — by design. Export on old device, transfer the JSON file, Import on new device.

Where does the monster and spell data come from?

The tracker uses Open5e, an open-source community project, via its v2 API. This includes both the **2014 (SRD 5.1)** and **2024 (SRD 5.2)** rules, alongside some third-party open-licensed content. Monster and spell data remain subject to their original licensing and attribution requirements.

Do you support the 2024 rules?

Yes. The database now includes the **2024 SRD (5.2)** monsters and spells alongside the 2014 SRD. Spells that exist in both editions show source pills so you can compare them. Note that the open SRD is a subset of the full printed 2024 Monster Manual — creatures unique to the printed book that aren't in the open SRD won't appear. For those, use **Parse Block** (paste the stat block, or a Tetra-cube export) to add them yourself.

What do the source tags mean?

Monsters show a short **source key** (e.g. SRD-2024); spells show the **ruleset edition** (2014 / 2024) or the sourcebook name. “Custom” marks anything you’ve added yourself.

Tag	Shown on	What it means
SRD	Monster	D&D 5e System Reference Document 5.1 — the free **2014** (“legacy”) ruleset.
SRD-2024	Monster	D&D 5e System Reference Document 5.2 — the free **2024** (“revised”) ruleset.
2014	Spell	The spell as written in the 2014 SRD (5.1).
2024	Spell	The spell as written in the 2024 SRD (5.2).
Custom / Custom	Monster & spell	Something you created in the custom editor, or imported with Parse Block (stat block or Tetra-cube).
A5E-AG / Level Up Advanced 5e	Monster / Spell	*Level Up: Advanced 5th Edition — Adventurer’s Guide* (EN Publishing, OGL).
TOB	Monster	*Tome of Beasts* (Kobold Press, OGL).
TOB2	Monster	*Tome of Beasts 2* (Kobold Press, OGL).
TOB3	Monster	*Tome of Beasts 3* (Kobold Press, OGL).
CC	Monster	*Creature Codex* (Kobold Press, OGL).
MM	Monster	*Monstrous Menagerie* (Level Up: Advanced 5e, EN Publishing, OGL) — the single largest set in the database.
BFRD	Monster	*Black Flag SRD* (Kobold Press “Tales of the Valiant” reference content).
TOB-2023	Monster	*Tome of Beasts 1 (2023 Edition)* (Kobold Press, OGL) — revised reprint, listed separately from the original.
Other	Spell	Fallback label for a source with no edition mapping and no title.

Why does a spell show 2014 / 2024 buttons?

Some spells exist in more than one ruleset. When that happens the spell sheet shows a pill per source — tap a pill to read that version's rules. Opened from a creature, it defaults to the edition matching that creature (falling back to 2014, then 2024). If a spell shows no pills, only one source carries it.

Can I switch between light and dark mode?

Yes — use the **Day / Night** toggle in the header. On first open the tracker matches your device's light/dark setting; your manual choice is then remembered. You can also pick from six accent colours and a high-legibility font in the **More** menu — see Appearance & Accessibility.

How do I add a player portrait?

In the XP / party panel, use the avatar control on a player's row to choose an image; it shows as a small rounded thumbnail on that player's card. The picture is shrunk to a thumbnail in your browser and only that compact copy is stored — the original is never kept or uploaded. Players without a portrait get an initials chip instead. See Appearance & Accessibility.

The monster database is not loading

Requires internet on first open. Check connection, refresh, wait up to 60 seconds. Once downloaded it will not need to download again.

Where can I support the creator?

Support the tracker at ko-fi.com/mitznsimz — and for miniatures to bring your encounter to life: mitznsimz.com

Thank you for using the MitzNSimz Encounter Tracker.

We hope it brings a little more adventure and a little less bookkeeping to your table.

— Pete & Mitz & Simz